From: Shirley Bennett
Sent: 13 Jun 2016 08:57:25 +0100
To: Scanning
Subject: FW: Planning Application Number: S/OUT/13/1555

Kind Regards

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'NOTE: Swindon Borough Council has an adopted and published Community Infrastructure Levy Charging Schedule. The Charging Schedule becomes effective from **6th April 2015**. For information on how this may affect your development proposal please visit www.swindon.gov.uk/cil'

From: [redacted]
Sent: 10 June 2016 11:02 PM
To: SBC Development Control
Subject: Planning Application Number: S/OUT/13/1555

Dear Sir or Madam,

Planning Application Number: S/OUT/13/1555
Address: *Eastern Villages North,, Eastern Villages, Swindon*
Proposal: *Outline planning application for up to 2,380 dwellings, mixed use local centres/areas, community uses, sheltered and/or care accommodation, up to two primary schools, green infrastructure including formal and informal open space, play space, sports facilities, sustainable drainage, engineering works and including ground re-modelling, other infrastructure, demolition and the formation of new accesses from the A420, Old Vicarage Lane and Thornhill Road.*
Case Officer: *Mr Edward Snook*

I am writing as a resident of South Marston and I object to this planning application.

This development will irrevocably change – for the worse – the village of South Marston. I am sure you are aware that the vast majority of residents are opposed to it. However, I understand that it will in all probability go ahead, so the aim must be to mitigate its adverse effects. My comments relating to this are below.

1. Roads and traffic.

1.1 The A420.

I travel on this road daily and witness at first hand how congested it is. Around the evening rush hour, the traffic travelling west towards Swindon is frequently backed up as far as the turning to Shrivenham and Bourton and even beyond. It defies belief that this road can accommodate the increase in traffic that this development alone will bring; and of course there will be further increases associated with the Symmetry Park development and the Eastern Villages. The A420 simply cannot cope with this.

1.2 Gablecross roundabout.

It is difficult already for traffic to access this roundabout from Thornhill Road. With the increased traffic on Thornhill Road from the South Marston development and the increased traffic on the A420 associated with the whole development, it can only get worse. At the very least, this junction should be signalised.

1.3 Rowborough.

Firstly, the main access from Rowborough to the A420 – i.e. the new railway tunnel – should be built before the Rowborough development commences. This will ensure that Rowborough construction traffic will have a limited impact on South Marston, and will also ensure that it does get built. This should be a condition of planning permission, if permission is granted.

Secondly, there should be no roads from Rowborough onto Old Vicarage Lane. They are not needed, and would compromise the green buffer between Rowborough and South Marston. They will encourage rat-running from Rowborough through South Marston to the Keypoint Roundabout to avoid the inevitable traffic congestion on the A420. Taking traffic from Rowborough onto Old Vicarage Lane and then under the single-lane railway bridge is clearly not sensible. Significant traffic congestion would be inevitable, and there is no scope for providing pedestrian or cycle access. It should be noted that there is no secondary school in either the South Marston or Rowborough proposals, so pupils will presumably have to attend the school in other parts of the Eastern Village Development. It is important that this can be done on foot or by cycle.

In summary, Rowborough traffic should join the A420 solely from the new access point, which should be constructed to allow for safe use by pedestrians and cyclists as well as road traffic.

2. Flooding.

I am concerned that the flood mitigation measures proposed may not be adequate. At present it is not uncommon for flooding to occur on Old Vicarage Lane, on the fields to the West of Old Vicarage Lane and on the A420 at Acorn Bridge, when we have heavy rain. Other commenters on this proposal have raised various other flood-related concerns, and all of these need to be addressed.

3. School.

If the existing South Marston school were to be expanded to meet the increased demand resulting from the new development it would inevitably result in increased traffic through Pound Corner. This is already an unsafe junction, with no dedicated pavement for pedestrians; there is no capacity for increased traffic. I would suggest that a better option would be to build a new, modern school located nearer to the new main road which would more safely accommodate the school-related traffic. It would also mean that the existing school building – one of the more distinguished buildings in the village – could be retained, perhaps for community use, without being spoiled by inappropriate extension.

Yours faithfully,

Susan Fitzpatrick.